

Organizing Résumés

- Chronological
- Functional
- Combination

Résumé Components

- Name and address
- Career objective or summary
- Academic credentials
- Employment history
- Activities and achievements
- Relevant personal data

Common Résumé Problems

- Inappropriate length
- Hard to read
- Wordy
- Too slick
- Poorly reproduced

- Amateurish

- Boastful

- Dishonest

- Gimmicky

- Carelessly written

Producing Traditional Résumés

- Clean typeface

- High-grade paper

- Ample margins

- Laser printed

- Appropriate length

- Professional design

Résumé Formats

1. Printed

2. ASCII-Text

3. HTML-Coded

Producing Scannable Résumés

- ASCII Format
- Document design
- Key words
- Buzzwords and jargon

Paper Résumés (1 of 5)

- Use white space effectively by providing adequate margins (about one inch on the sides and one to one and one-half inches at the top and bottom), by leaving sufficient space between columns (to 1 inch), and by clearly separating one section from another.
- For résumés of more than one page, you should also ensure the first page is well balanced and substantial without appearing crowded.

Paper Résumés (2 of 5)

- Use a font size and a font style that is easy to read (for example, a serifed font of at least 11 points for most of the text of the résumé).
- For the headings, you may choose to use a larger, sans-serif font.

Paper Résumés (3 of 5)

- Design your résumés with busy readers in mind, arranging information so that it is easy to find. For example, isolate dates by listing them down one side of the page rather than embedding them in descriptions of employment history, education, etc.
- When you must begin a new page in the middle of a section, ensure the page break falls between items, such as between job descriptions in the employment section

Paper Résumés (4 of 5)

- Because many people may handle a résumé, we suggest you put your first initial and last name followed by the page number at the top right-hand corner of additional pages (i.e., H. Brown, 2).
- Use the best-quality paper possible for your résumé and cover letter. Always print originals on a laser printer so that the print is crisp, clean, and dark, and if you require photocopies, consider spending a few extra cents per copy to have them copied on good-quality paper on a well-serviced machine.

Paper Résumés (5 of 5)

- To ensure that your résumé is error free, edit it extremely carefully. Triple check everything, including the spelling of your name, your address and phone number, and the dates in your education and employment sections.
- When you are sure that your résumé is error free, ask at least one other person to read for errors and to comment on layout and content

Scannable Résumés (1 of 4)

- Use key words that the employer is most likely to use
- Use a very plain format
- List as many facts, skills, and attributes as possible
- Use descriptive nouns and noun phrases wherever possible
- Employ technical language, but avoid abbreviations

Scannable Résumés (2 of 4)

- Place your full name on a line by itself as the first item on each page.
- State your employment objective using key words that match a particular job description or that are commonly used for the type of position you are applying for.
- Provide a section for your relevant employment history or experience.
- List degrees and degree majors.
- Provide sections that list skills, qualifications, accomplishments, licenses, and certifications.

Scannable Résumés (3 of 4)

- Put contact information on different lines and if you list more than one phone number, put each on a separate line. Also use the standard address format:

Herman D. Brown
1234 Underwood Street
Chicago, IL 61811

- Left justify the entire document, avoid columns, and use at least one-inch margins.

Scannable Résumés (4 of 4)

- Use standard fonts and reduce formatting features to a minimum. Font size should be 10 to 12 point and the font should be a standard one. Avoid tabs, italics, underlining, brackets, bullets, dashes, horizontal or vertical lines, shading, symbols, and pictures.
- Use white space to indicate where one section ends and another begins. You may also use bolding and capitals for headings, but ensure letters do not touch each other.
- If the résumé is printed, use white paper and a laser printer to produce crisp, dark

type on one side of the page only. Do not fold or staple. If the résumé is to be e-mailed, save the file in ASCII or plain text format.

The Good CV

CV Basics

- Always remember that your CV is a marketing document and you are the product

you are marketing.

The power of words

- Scrutinize every word to ensure that each is doing its job properly. For eg.

appointed Could become Promoted to or selected as

Site/unit Could become Cost centre or profit centre

ran Could become Created and developed

supervised Could become Trained and motivated

Closed the . . . Could become

Chose to run down the. . .

Verbs are essential for impact

Started Introduced Re-established

Initiated Created Generated

Developed Trimmed Organised

Enhanced Tightened up

Definite don'ts

1. Omitting something the Organization asked for in the advertisement or subsequently
2. Fudging periods of employment, or giving only partial disclosure of qualifications, education or job responsibilities
3. Using self-regarding descriptions of your charisma, leadership, and communication skills
4. Trying to be funny
5. Using jargon – whether of your own profession or that of your career consultant

Definite don'ts (contd....)

6. Franking your letters instead of using stamps
7. Failing to check the documents you're sending out or to use the word processor spellcheck
8. Getting the recipient's name, job title, address or post code wrong
9. Getting the job title you're applying for wrong

Definite don'ts (contd....)

10. Using the words that you ought to avoid:

- Charisma / charismatic
- Leader and leadership
- Commence (use 'start' or 'begin')
- In terms of or with regard to
- Challenge
- Peruse or perusal